

Jonathan Rubeck Match Prep Report

Opponent: Jonathan Rubeck | rating 1894 | FIDE 435678 | Hendon | no credible Chess.com account found

Bottom line: Jonathan Rubeck looks like a balanced practical player with repeatable systems and enough tactical bite to punish drift player. This report is based on 213 source PGNs, 191 deduped games, with known dates spanning 2014.08.23 to 2026.05.04. Most recent parsed game: 2026.05.04 Ashton, Alannah - Rubeck, Jonathan 1-0.

Evidence	Value
Source PGNs	213
Deduped games used	191
Overall score in sample	93.5/190 (49.2%)
White score	54.5/101 (54.0%)
Black score	39/89 (43.8%)
Last 10 dated games	2.5/10 (25.0%)
Since 2025	12/34 (35.3%)
Confidence	High for opening/recency counts; medium for style, strengths and weaknesses without a fresh engine pass.

1. Style, Strengths And Weaknesses

Style read: balanced practical player with repeatable systems and enough tactical bite to punish drift. The most important practical clue is not a single opening name, but the repeatability of his early structures shown below.

Main strengths	Main weaknesses
large public sample with repeated tournament structures, so his main habits are visible; clear White comfort zone around Caro-Kann as White, Alapin / anti-Sicilian; clear Black comfort zone around French Defence, KID/fianchetto vs flank; recent activity in the sample, so old repertoire notes should not be used alone	predictable first-move families as White if you prepare the exact move order; repeated Black structures that let you choose a targeted anti-system rather than broad prep; some repertoire clustering: he can be made to solve a prepared branch rather than choose freely

2. His White Repertoire

Family	Games	Score	Most common exact setup
Caro-Kann as White	18	13/18 (72.2%)	1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. h4 h5 5. c4 e6
Alapin / anti-Sicilian	17	8.5/17 (50.0%)	1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 d6
Grand Prix / Closed Sicilian	17	7/17 (41.2%)	1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bc4 e6
Scotch/Open Game central d4	14	12/14 (85.7%)	1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. e5 d5
French as White	12	3/12 (25.0%)	1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 c5 5. g3 Nc6
Pirc/Modern as White	7	0/7 (0.0%)	1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. f4 c6 4. Nf3 d5 5. e5 h5
1.e4 vs d5	6	4/6 (66.7%)	1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Qxd5 3. Nc3 Qa5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 Bf5
1.e4 e5 Open Game as White	3	1/3 (33.3%)	1. e4 e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. f4 d5 4. fxe5 Nxe4 5. Nf3 Nxc3

Most repeated White setup fragments

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. e5 d5 (9 games)
1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bc4 e6 (8 games)
1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. h4 h5 5. c4 e6 (4 games)
1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. dxc5 e6 5. a3 Bxc5 (4 games)
1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 d6 (3 games)

3. His Black Repertoire

Family	Games	Score	Most common exact setup
French Defence	30	9.5/30 (31.7%)	1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. f4 c5
KID/fianchetto vs flank	12	5.5/12 (45.8%)	1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 g6 3. e4 d6 4. d4 Bg7 5. h3 O-O
KID / ...d6 fianchetto	9	7/9 (77.8%)	1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O
Scandinavian Defence	9	5/9 (55.6%)	1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Nf6 3. Bb5 Bd7 4. Bc4 Bg4 5. Nf3 Nxd5
Gruenfeld/neo-Gruenfeld ...d5	6	1/6 (16.7%)	1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 d5 3. Nd2 g6 4. Bxf6 exf6 5. e3 Bg7
QGD structure	6	3/6 (50.0%)	1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O
Symmetrical/Queen-pawn ...d5+...c5 vs flank	5	0/5 (0.0%)	1. Nf3 d5 2. b3 e6 3. Bb2 Nf6 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O
Nimzo/QID/Bogo family	3	1/3 (33.3%)	1. d4 Nf6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bf4 e6 4. Nb5 Na6 5. e3 Be7

Most repeated Black setup fragments

- 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. f4 c5 (6 games)
- 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. e5 Nfd7 5. Bd3 c5 (5 games)
- 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Qb6 5. Nf3 Bd7 (5 games)
- 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e5 Nfd7 (4 games)
- 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O (2 games)

Fianchetto shell note: in 34 d4/flank games where he used ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7, the split is ...d6/KID-ish: 21, ...d5/Gruenfeld-ish: 13. Use the early d-pawn choice as the cue: ...d6 means KID/Benoni thinking, ...d5 means Catalan/Gruenfeld-style central pressure.

4. Recent Form And Recent Openings

Recent form snapshot: last 10 dated games score 2.5/10 (25.0%); since 2025 score 12/34 (35.3%). The table below separates current move orders from older historical preferences.

Date	Side	Opponent	Result	Setup
2026.05.04	Black	Ashton, Alannah	1-0	Scandinavian Defence: 1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Nf6 3. d4 Nxd5 4. Nf3 g6
2026.01.10	White	Xian, Junhao	0-1	Alapin / anti-Sicilian: 1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 e6
2026.01.02	White	Rayner, Francis	0-1	Grand Prix / Closed Sicilian: 1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7
2026.01.01	Black	Blanquet, Camille	1-0	Gruenfeld/neo-Gruenfeld ...d5: 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 d5 4. Nf3 Bg7
2026.01.01	White	Onuoha, Obioma	1-0	Italian / Scotch Gambit as White: 1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Bc4 Nxe4 4. Nc3 Nxc3
2025.12.31	Black	Vaidyanathan, Adithya	1-0	KID/fianchetto vs flank: 1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 g6 3. e4 d6 4. d4 Bg7
2025.12.30	White	Saxena, Reyansh	1-0	French as White: 1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Bd3 dxe4 4. Bxe4 f5
2025.12.30	Black	Verbin, Valentina	1-0	Scandinavian Defence: 1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Nf6 3. d4 Nxd5 4. Nf3 g6

5. Game Plan For Lachlan

If You Are Black

Against 1.e4, choose your most familiar defence over novelty-hunting. He has enough open-game/Sicilian experience that a half-known sharp line is the real danger.

If You Are White

If he answers 1.e4 with the French, use standard pressure on d4/e5 and keep an eye on early ...c5/...Qb6. Avoid spending tempi on flank play before the centre is stable.

Against ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7, stay in Catalan/Reti mode: c4, g3, Bg2, d4, keep central tension, and decide early whether dxe5/dxc5 clarifies in your favour.

Practical Match Plan

Do not chase tactics unless the forcing line is fully calculated; make compensation prove itself.

Trade into better structure when he accepts isolated pawns, backward pawns, or a weak colour complex.

Prepare one forcing branch against the top repeated setup, then spend the rest of prep on plans and pawn breaks rather than memorising sidelines.

6. Before-The-Round Checklist

Review your French response: Advance/Exchange/Tarrasch choice, with special attention to ...c5 and ...Qb6.

Review White rep / Reti and Catalan files against ...Nf6/...g6/...Bg7; decide dxc5/dxe5 trigger points.

Bring one practical target to the board: a pawn break, a trade into better structure, or a line that removes his favourite attacking plan.

7. Appendix: Representative Setups

Side	Setup family	Representative line	Read over the board
His White	Caro-Kann as White	1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. f3 dxe4 4. fxe4 e5 5. Nf3 exd4 6. Bd3 Bg4	Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves.
His White	Alapin / anti-Sicilian	1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 d6 6. Nf3 Nc6	Use a familiar defence; he is comfortable in open/semi-open play.
His White	Grand Prix / Closed Sicilian	1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 e6 3. f4 a6 4. Nf3 b5 5. d3 Nf6 6. g3 d5	Use a familiar defence; he is comfortable in open/semi-open play.
His White	Scotch/Open Game central d4	1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Bc5 5. c3 d3 6. Qxd3 Nge7	Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves.
His White	French as White	1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 a6 5. g3 c5 6. Bg2 Nc6	Prepare the pawn break and piece placement, not just the first two moves.
His Black	French Defence	1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Bd7 6. Be2 f6	Develop cleanly and punish early queen/pawn looseness without overpressing.
His Black	KID/fianchetto vs flank	1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 g6 3. g3 Bg7 4. d4 O-O 5. e4 d6 6. Bg2 Nc6	Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing.
His Black	KID / ...d6 fianchetto	1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. bxa6 Bxa6 6. Nc3 g6	Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing.
His Black	Scandinavian Defence	1. e4 d5 2. Nc3 dxe4 3. Nxe4 e5 4. Nf3 f5 5. Nc3 e4 6. Ne5 Nf6	Develop cleanly and punish early queen/pawn looseness without overpressing.
His Black	Gruenfeld/neo-Gruenfeld ...d5	1. d4 Nf6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bf4 g6 4. f3 Bg7 5. e4 dxe4 6. fxe4 Bg4	Catalan/Reti pressure; keep central tension and watch ...c5/...e5 timing.

8. Sources And Limits

Local En Croissant prep folder PGNs, with one-game files and .info sidecars from local Mega, Chess-Results and Lichess broadcasts where available.

Raw source files: 213; deduped games used in this report: 191.

No fresh engine pass was run. Tactical, positional, strength and weakness conclusions are scouting inferences from openings, results, structures and representative games.